# Beginner's Guide to Monitoring Your App

Monitoring tells you if your application is healthy, slow, or completely broken before your users complain. Learning these basic commands helps you solve problems in minutes instead of hours.

**What you'll learn:**

1. Reading Live Logs with Tail
2. Finding Errors with Grep
3. Checking Server Health with Htop
4. Checking Storage Space with DF

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## Reading Live Logs with Tail

Logs are text files where your application writes down everything it does. When something goes wrong, the answer is almost always in the logs. Using the tail command lets you watch new log entries appear in real-time as users click on your website.

```
$ tail -f /var/log/syslog
```

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## Finding Errors with Grep

Log files can be thousands of lines long, making it impossible to read everything manually. The grep command acts like a search function for your terminal, instantly pulling out only the lines that contain words like ERROR or FAIL.

```
$grep -i "error" /var/log/nginx/error.log
```

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## Checking Server Health with Htop

When your application feels sluggish, you need to check if your server is out of resources. Htop gives you a colorful, easy-to-read dashboard showing how much CPU and memory your programs are currently using.

```
$htop
```

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## Checking Storage Space with DF

Applications often crash unexpectedly when the server runs out of disk space because they cannot write temporary files or logs. Running df -h shows you available storage in a human-readable format like gigabytes.

```
$df -h
```

See Key Takeaways on next page >> linkedin.com/in/mramanrajsingh

## Key Takeaways

- + Always check your log files first when debugging an issue
- + Keep an eye on disk space before running large database backups
- + Use descriptive log levels like INFO, WARN, and ERROR
- + Test your monitoring commands on a staging server first
- + Write down the common commands on a sticky note near your desk

## Watch Out For

- ! Panicking and restarting the server without checking the logs first
- ! Ignoring disk space warnings until the entire server crashes
- ! Printing sensitive user passwords or keys inside application logs

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